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The study of variation under domestication shows how much animals and plants can change when breeders choose which individuals leave offspring. Pigeons, dogs and cabbages all trace back to a few wild forms, yet their descendants differ in ways no one would predict from the ancestors.

Variability is governed by many unknown laws, of which correlated growth is probably the most important. A change in one part of an organism often brings changes in others that nobody chose.

In nature the struggle for existence follows from the rapid rate at which all organic beings tend to increase. Every creature produces more offspring than can possibly survive on the food at hand.

Hence the individuals that vary even slightly in a useful direction have a better chance of surviving and of passing the useful variation on to their young.

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